Android Pay gets expanded with Chrome integration

Google is aggressively pushing Android Pay to reach the masses. After enabling mobile payments from smartphones, the search giant has now released a new Chrome version to bring its payment system to the Web.

With the latest Chrome 53 for Android, Google has introduced PaymentRequest API support. This enables the Web browser to leverage Android Pay and make direct payments at online stores. *Group, 1-800-Flowers.com* and similar other sites will be part of the pilot release.

Users do not need to type any billing address, shipping details and payer information while making payments through the new method. Android Pay automatically fills the information on the payment forms.

The release of the PaymentRequest API suggests that Google is aiming to offer the mobile payment option not only on Chrome, but also on other browsers and platforms. Developers will also be able to utilise this new Web standard to enhance online payments.

In addition to Android Pay on Chrome, Google has partnered with Uber to encourage users to make payments through its platform.

Google is tokenising the account number to mask the users' identity. Users can track their purchases through Android Pay. The card integration in Android Pay is highly secure. You need an NFC-enabled smartphone running Android 4.4 or later to use the service. The app makes purchases by charging the integrated credit/debit card.

Apple Pay and Samsung Pay are tough competitors for Android Pay. However, Android Pay through Chrome 53 makes it a unique offering by Google. It is expected to add a strong value proposition to the Android platform.

Chamber, in his theme address of the conference, highlighted the fact that e-governance integrated governance with people, processes and information technology. Anand optimistically said that India is likely to soon emerge as a leader in e-governance, considering the country's success with e-commerce and IT.

Narendra of Ernst & Young India, in his talk on 'Global Learning for a Feasible and Sustainable model of UHC (universal health coverage) in India', mentioned six pillars of UHC that are defined by the World Health Organisation. These include healthcare financing, availability of essential medicines and healthcare products, policies, motivated workforce and availability of information statistics and information systems. He added that there is a lot of work happening in India on healthcare delivery, which is at par with global practices.

Prof. Sarbadhikari talked on 'e-Health in Digital India'. He revealed that the government is about to release its revised guidelines for electronic health records (EHR). He also stated that alongside e-health, sanitation and nutrition are equally vital in the good health model.

With the rise of smartphone and Internet users in the country, the government is reducing the complexity of the healthcare system and providing services online in the form of websites like Data.gov.in and National Health Portal (NHP), Prof. Sarbadhikari added.

Vivek Seigell, director of PHD Chamber, in the plenary session, said that a regulatory mechanism to promote and cultivate the habit of creating health data has to be developed in the country, and the ongoing growth of the IT industry will enhance healthcare developments.

Life Insurance Council and the Association of Healthcare Providers India (AHPI) were the associate partners for the conference. The EFY Group, the parent company of *Open Source For You*, was among its media partners.

VMware adopts open source strategy to bring containers closer to enterprises

VMware has announced the open source availability of its vSphere Integrated Containers. This lets enterprises quickly leverage containers for their production operations. The company has also developed two new capabilities for its container solution to provide a Docker compatible interface to various IT teams.

Originally unveiled in August 2015, VMware's vSphere Integrated Containers is a one-stop solution for enterprises that are looking for a container infrastructure integrated with Docker, Kubernetes and Cloud Foundry. But it was not a fully-customised option in the initial stages. Thus, the open source plan has now been sketched out as follows.

Instead of just giving old wine in a new bottle, VMware is offering the open source community a whole new solution. It has Admiral and Harbor as the new capabilities. While Admiral enables acceleration of application delivery, Harbor brings a container registry along with Docker support.

The new tools help enterprises move their containerised applications into production, irrespective of their on-premise or public cloud environments.

"Relying on our enterprise know-how, we are delivering VMware vSphere Integrated Containers to dramatically simplify the delivery of containers and application services into production in virtual environments, whether on-premise or in the public cloud. Application development teams can benefit from the flexibility, portability and speed of containers while IT benefits from the security,